THEMIS

Themis turns a legal request into a matter, an analysis, and a record.

And it catches the question nobody asked.

FOUNDER

Brian Harris, sole founder. 17 years in-house counsel: founding GC/CCO at Settle, founding CLO/CCO at Manifest, product and regulatory counsel leadership at Affirm. M.S. Computer Science, Georgia Tech, with AI research in document classification and redaction. J.D.

BUILT FOR

Legal teams of one to three at U.S. technology and fintech companies, with no legal ops function and no procurement process for new tools.

Working prototype. Raising a $1.5M pre-seed to hire the first engineer.

In-house lawyers lose the week before they ever reach the legal question.

The problem isn't that nothing is saved. It's that the reasoning behind past decisions isn't.

THE REAL GAP

Lawyers already have a Drive folder, a DMS, a precedent bank and Slack search. Things are saved.

What is not saved is the reasoning: why a past decision went the way it did.

"half-baked" how one general counsel described the requests that arrive over Slack, email, tickets and drop-bys, missing purpose, permissions and timing.

~20%

of a general counsel's week goes to drafting. About two-thirds goes to meetings and committee work; the rest to staying current and holding context.

OUR READ

Many of those meetings exist because the reasoning behind a decision made months earlier is not retrievable, so the room re-derives it live, every time.

Four in-house counsel interviews, August 2026. Participants described by role only. The time estimate is one general counsel's own account, not a survey. "Our read" is our inference from those conversations, not a finding.

Seventeen years of malformed requests, encoded into how Themis reads an intake.

Themis orders its questions by how much each would change the recommendation, most decision-changing first.

FOUR RECURRING SHAPES OF THE MISSED QUESTION

01 Missing purpose

The request names an activity but not the purpose the data or capability will serve.

02 Bundled uses

The request bundles two different uses as one, when each has a different answer.

03 Missing timing

The request omits the timing that controls the analysis: a renewal, a launch date.

04 Assumed permission

The request assumes an existing permission or consent already covers a new use.

The matter on slide 05 shows shapes 02, 03 and 04 inside a single request.

WHY NOBODY WRITES IT DOWN

Recording the reasoning afterwards feels like homework on a decision already made, and it has no natural home. Themis captures it during the work, not after.

THE TEST WE ARE COMMITTING TO

By December 15, 2026, report the share of pilot matters that end in a recorded decision without the lawyer being asked to write one.

Target: 70%

WHO ELSE IS HERE

Claude, ChatGPT, Harvey, Legora, CoCounsel and GC AI all produce a first pass. Onit, SimpleLegal and Brightflag manage spend for larger departments. A lean team's real alternative is a Drive folder and a Claude Project.

The four shapes are drawn from the founder's in-house practice and are already encoded in the product's intake agent. Depth is the ordering by decision impact and the accumulation across matters, not the four examples.

A Claude Project is a folder someone remembers to curate.

Themis assembles the same stack, on every request, whether anyone remembers to or not.

Each recorded decision becomes context for the next matter, which sharpens the next first pass, which produces the next record.

THE TAX

Every new question pays a setup cost: the company, what it sells, how money and data move, which regulators matter, what was already decided.

THE STACK

Every request assembles the same context stack, automatically, before any analysis starts. The company profile is never optional.

THE VAULT

It reads from standing folders: playbooks, a living company-knowledge file, and every prior matter, in plain Markdown the lawyer can open and edit.

DECISION MAINTENANCE

A standing watch system does decision maintenance: when the law underneath a recorded decision moves, the decision resurfaces. The alternative is that nobody notices it went stale.

ASSEMBLED ON EVERY REQUEST, IN THIS ORDER

Identity and agent standards	Soul.md · Agents.md
The lawyer	user.md
The company	company.md
Durable observations	memory.md
This matter and its prior decisions	03_Matters/
The document open right now	active file

↓

The first pass

This describes the shipped mechanism, not a measured result. Claude and ChatGPT both offer persistent memory and projects; the claim here is about who assembles the context, in what order, and whether it can be skipped.

Two legal leaders have agreed to try it.

Both commitments are verbal and unpriced. Here is the plan to firm them up, and the product on one matter.

Head of legal, data company

Committed to pilot at release and is scoping AI budget. Verbal and unpriced.

Deputy GC, consumer fintech

Agreed to be a design partner. Verbal and unpriced. Team size still to be confirmed against the customer profile.

THE PLAN TO FIRM THEM UP

Prototype walkthrough with each contact by October 15, 2026. Start date agreed by November 1, 2026.

WORKED EXAMPLE · FICTIONAL MATTER, SEEDED IN THE PROTOTYPE

Product asked one question. It was two.

REQUIRED WORK

Select the customer reauthentication path

Stage: Waiting on your judgment. Brian Harris must act next: Select the customer reauthentication path

Matter at a glance

Relay is moving about 280,000 customers from credential-based bank connections to OAuth and bank APIs. Product prefers to let existing connections continue until a bank requires reauthentication, while Growth wants to use two years of transaction history for card and lending offers. The current consent does not clearly disclose these uses or set a deletion period after disconnection. Legal guidance is needed before the aggregator contract renews on September 15.

Question to resolve

Should Relay let existing bank connections continue until each customer must reauthenticate, or require all 280,000 customers to reauthorize within 90 days? In either case, should marketing and lending uses require separate consent, and should disconnected-account data be deleted after 30 days?

A company moving 280,000 customers off shared bank credentials onto OAuth. Themis split the continuity question from the monetization question, and surfaced the consent and deletion questions the business had not asked.

Fictional company and volume, seeded in the prototype to demonstrate product behaviour. Not a customer, and not a validated legal conclusion.

Models just got good enough to produce a usable legal first pass. That capability is also the risk.

If the value lives only in the model, the next release captures it. The record is what keeps it with the lawyer.

+87%

growth in U.S. in-house counsel, 2008 to 2024, against +23% for law firm lawyers and +38% for government lawyers.

~$82M

17,003 U.S. legal departments under $1B revenue, at $4,800 a year. First seats alone, bottom up.

~$245M

the same departments at an average of three seats, before the 5,235 departments above $1B. A model, not a forecast.

WHAT THE INCUMBENTS REQUIRE

Harvey, per one buyer's account of their own quote: a five-seat minimum on a twelve-month term. GC AI sells a self-serve single seat at $500 a month.

HOW WE LAND AND EXPAND

We land one lawyer at $400 a month, monthly, no term. That same department at three seats is $14,400 a year, against a single-seat product.

Raising $1.5M pre-seed

Counsel growth: ACC analysis of BLS data. Department counts: secondary estimate from a buildlegaltech.com analysis citing Dun & Bradstreet/NetWise and U.S. Census Economic Survey. Expansion figure models mature adoption and is not a forecast. Harvey terms are one anonymous buyer's account, not a published or verified rate. The beachhead segment is not independently sized.